25901023 Scheme for Valuation
MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025
First SEMESTER
Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCBFS100 - BUSINESSOPERATIONS
(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
Duration: 1 Hour Maximum Marks: 50
Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I)and Appreciation(Ap)
Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overalloutcome attainability.

Part A Very Short Answer Questions
Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. Explain how resource allocation influences cost control. [An] / [CO1]
Efficient resource allocation ensures that labour, materials, and capital are used optimally without wastage. When resources are properly assigned to high-priority activities, unnecessary expenses reduce, leading to better cost control.

2. Explain how trade barriers impact global competitiveness. [U] / [CO2]
Trade barriers such as tariffs and quotas increase the cost of imports and restrict market access. This reduces a country's or firm's ability to compete globally by limiting efficiency, innovation, and international market reach.

3. Illustrate how consumer awareness promotes ethical business conduct. [U] / [CO3]
When consumers are aware of their rights and market practices, firms are compelled to act ethically to maintain trust. This awareness discourages unfair practices and motivates businesses to follow transparency and accountability.

4. Give any two examples of services. [U] / [CO3]
Examples of services include banking services and healthcare services. These offer intangible benefits rather than physical products.

5. Describe how quality control processes prevent defects. [An] / [CO1]
Quality control uses inspections, testing, and standard procedures to detect issues during production. Early identification of problems prevents defective products from reaching customers and reduces rework costs.

6. Explain how an operational plan translates strategic goals into daily activities. [U] / [CO1]
An operational plan breaks long-term strategic goals into specific tasks, schedules, and responsibilities. It ensures day-to-day actions directly support the organisation's broader objectives.

7. Describe how innovation policy enhances competitiveness in business. [U] / [CO2]
Innovation policies encourage research, new technologies, and creative solutions. Businesses adopting these innovations improve productivity and differentiate themselves, strengthening competitiveness.

8. Summarise how globalisation changed business environment. [An] / [CO2]
Globalisation has expanded markets, increased competition, and enabled faster technology transfer. It has also encouraged companies to adopt global standards and improve efficiency to survive in a borderless economy.

9. Explain touchpoints in service delivery. [U] / [CO3]
Touchpoints are the various interactions a customer has with a service provider—before, during, and after the service. These include website visits, customer support, physical branches, and follow-up communication, shaping overall customer experience.

10. Analyse how features of a product influence buying business decisions. [An] / [CO3]
Product features such as quality, durability, design, and performance directly affect business buyer preferences. Businesses choose products that offer reliability and value, reducing operational risks and costs.

11. Define wandering consumer. [U] / [CO3]
A wandering consumer is a customer who visits a store without a specific intention to buy and mainly browses. Their behaviour is driven by curiosity or leisure rather than a purchase need.

12. Explain how consumer satisfaction influences business reputation. [U] / [CO3]
Satisfied consumers are more likely to recommend the business and share positive feedback. This enhances the company's reputation and creates a loyal customer base, which is vital for long-term success.

Part B Short Answer Questions
Answer any 6 questions Each question carries 5 marks
13. Explain PESTEL analysis? [U] / [CO2]
PESTEL analysis is a strategic tool used to examine the external macro-environmental factors influencing a business. It includes Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, and Legal factors. By analysing these elements, organisations can anticipate risks and identify new opportunities. It also helps firms understand market dynamics and adapt strategies accordingly. Overall, PESTEL supports better long-term decision-making.

14. Appraise the effect of customer segmentation on marketing strategy formulation. [U] / [CO1]
Customer segmentation divides the market into groups with similar needs, preferences, or behaviours. This allows businesses to create targeted marketing strategies that better match customer expectations. Segmentation helps optimise resource allocation, focusing efforts on the most profitable segments. It also improves customer satisfaction by delivering personalised offerings. Overall, segmentation strengthens competitive advantage and enhances marketing effectiveness.

15. Identify three features of smartphones that enhance user experience. [U] / [CO3]
Smartphones today offer high-resolution touchscreens that provide clear visuals and smooth navigation. They also include advanced cameras with multiple lenses, improving photo and video quality. Another key feature is fast processing power, enabling multitasking and quicker app performance. Together, these features make smartphones more convenient and user-friendly. They significantly improve overall functionality and satisfaction.

16. Briefly explain the differences between product and services. [U] / [CO3]
Products are tangible items that can be touched, stored, and owned, while services are intangible and cannot be physically possessed. Products have a uniform quality, whereas services often vary depending on the provider and situation. Services are produced and consumed simultaneously, but products can be produced, stored, and consumed later. Products can be returned or resold, but services cannot. These distinctions guide how marketers design strategies for each.

17. Explain how operational control mechanisms maintain performance standards. [U] / [CO1]
Operational control mechanisms involve setting performance benchmarks and continuously monitoring actual results. They help managers detect deviations from planned objectives at an early stage. Corrective actions are then taken to improve efficiency and minimise wastage. These mechanisms also motivate employees to follow established procedures and quality norms. Ultimately, operational control ensures smooth functioning and consistent output.

18. How does social environment influence businesses? [U] / [CO2]
The social environment includes cultural values, lifestyle trends, demographics, and societal attitudes. These elements shape consumer preferences and influence purchasing behaviour. Businesses must adapt their products, marketing strategies, and services to align with social expectations. Failure to consider social trends can reduce brand relevance or acceptance. Thus, social factors significantly affect business decisions and long-term sustainability.

19. Discuss how time management principles increase productivity in operations. [U] / [CO1]
Time management ensures that tasks are prioritised and completed within deadlines. It reduces delays, eliminates unnecessary activities, and improves workflow efficiency. Proper scheduling and delegation allow employees to focus on high-value tasks. This leads to improved operational output and reduced stress levels. Overall, good time management practices enhance productivity and support organisational goals.

20. How do financial resources affect the internal environment? [U] / [CO2]
Financial resources determine a company's ability to invest in technology, talent, and growth initiatives. Adequate funds support smooth operations, innovation, and expansion. Limited resources, however, restrict decision-making and slow down organisational progress. Financial health also affects employee morale and stakeholder confidence. Therefore, strong financial resources create stability and strengthen the internal environment.

21. Explain the procedure of execution of an Operational Plan. [U] / [CO1]
Execution of an operational plan begins with clearly defining tasks, roles, and responsibilities. Resources such as manpower, budget, and equipment are allocated as per the plan. Activities are then scheduled and implemented through coordinated efforts. Continuous monitoring helps identify variances and ensures adherence to timelines. Finally, performance is evaluated, and corrective actions are taken to improve results.

22. Examine how technology integration enhances operational efficiency in business. [U] / [CO1]
Technology integration automates repetitive tasks, reducing manual effort and errors. It improves communication and coordination through digital tools and platforms. Real-time data analytics support faster and more informed decision-making. Additionally, technology upgrades streamline production, logistics, and customer service. Overall, technology significantly boosts productivity, accuracy, and business performance.